Project DT-II: Ontologies, Multi-agent Digital Twin and Intelligent Telemetry for the Internet Infrastructure

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Abstract

The Internet Infrastructure is dynamic and heterogeneous, which makes its governance difficult through manual procedures and vendor-specific models. This paper presents DT-II, an ontology-driven multi-agent Digital Twin designed to represent, monitor, and govern this infrastructure semantically. The proposal defines an Upper Ontology, grounded in the Unified Foundational Ontology (UFO) and modelled in OntoUML, centred on the triad `Node-Connection-Channel`. The model is formalised in Description Logic and operationalised as a Knowledge Graph, whose instance base (ABox) is continuously synchronised via model-driven telemetry (e.g., YANG-Push). On this basis, DT-II applies automated reasoning (TBox/RBox/ABox) to support semantic interoperability, fault detection/diagnosis, and compliance checks (e.g., SLAs and Ontological Compliance Regime). Finally, the system is organised as a multi-agent architecture based on MAPE-K, enabling explainable and policy-driven actions across heterogeneous network domains.

Keywords Domain Ontology · Foundational Ontology · UFO · OntoUML · NETCONF · Multi-agent Digital Twin

1 Introduction

The Internet Infrastructure (II) has become **highly** dynamic and heterogeneous, making it unreliable to govern solely through manual procedures, *ad hoc* scripts, and vendor-specific interpretations. In this context, ***Knowledge Graphs*** (KGs) have been employed to represent the operational state as connected facts, whilst ***ontologies*** provide the vocabulary,

constraints, and consistency criteria that render these facts interpretable and verifiable (Kejriwal, Knoblock, and Szekely 2021; Landgrebe and Smith 2025; Talisman 2026; Juliao Braga, Henriques, et al. 2025). In DT-II, the ontology defines the logical framework (classes, relations, and axioms), and the KG represents its instantiation, continuously updated.

This paper proposes a ***Upper Ontology***[1] (UO) for II (Arp, Smith, and Spear 2015), grounded in the Unified Foundational Ontology (UFO) and formalised in Description Logic (DL) (Baader et al. 2017; Nardi and Brachman 2010; Horrocks, Kutz, and Sattler 2006). In practical terms, the UO acts as a **Normative Ontological Basis**, which establishes core concepts and common rules to unify heterogeneous subdomains (e.g., 5G, satellite, and optical) around the triad **Node–Connection–Channel**. Modelling in OntoUML/OLED separates *types* bearing identity (Kind) from *functions* dependent on context (Role), which favours systematic validation and export to OWL/Turtle (Guerson et al. 2015; Guizzardi et al. 2018; W3C OWL Working Group 2012). Complementarily, according to (Nardi and Brachman 2003), page 13, a typical DL-based knowledge base consists of two components: a ***TBox*** and an ***ABox***. They continue: the ***TBox*** contains intensional knowledge in the form of a terminology (hence the term "***TBox***"; but "taxonomy" could also be used) and is built through declarations that describe general properties of concepts. Due to the nature of subsumption relationships among the concepts that constitute the terminology, ***TBoxes*** are usually regarded as having a lattice-like structure; this mathematical structure is entailed by the subsumption relationship — it has nothing to do with any implementation. The ***ABox*** contains extensional knowledge — also called assertional knowledge (hence the term "***ABox***") — knowledge that is specific to the individuals of the domain of discourse. Intensional knowledge is generally considered not to change — "timeless", in a way — whereas extensional knowledge is seen as contingent, or dependent on a particular set of circumstances, and therefore subject to occasional or even constant change. (Baader et al. 2017), on page 209, describes that in DL $\mathcal{SROIQ}$, the $\mathcal{S}$ is used as an abbreviation of DL in its simplest form, named $\mathcal{ALC}$, and that the letter $\mathcal{R}$ denotes an extended set of axioms representing the roles, which constitute the so-called ***RBox***. Thus, there are three components that constitute a knowledge base in DL (or OWL): ***TBox***, ***ABox***, and ***RBox***, systematically characterised in this document and and shown in Figure 1.

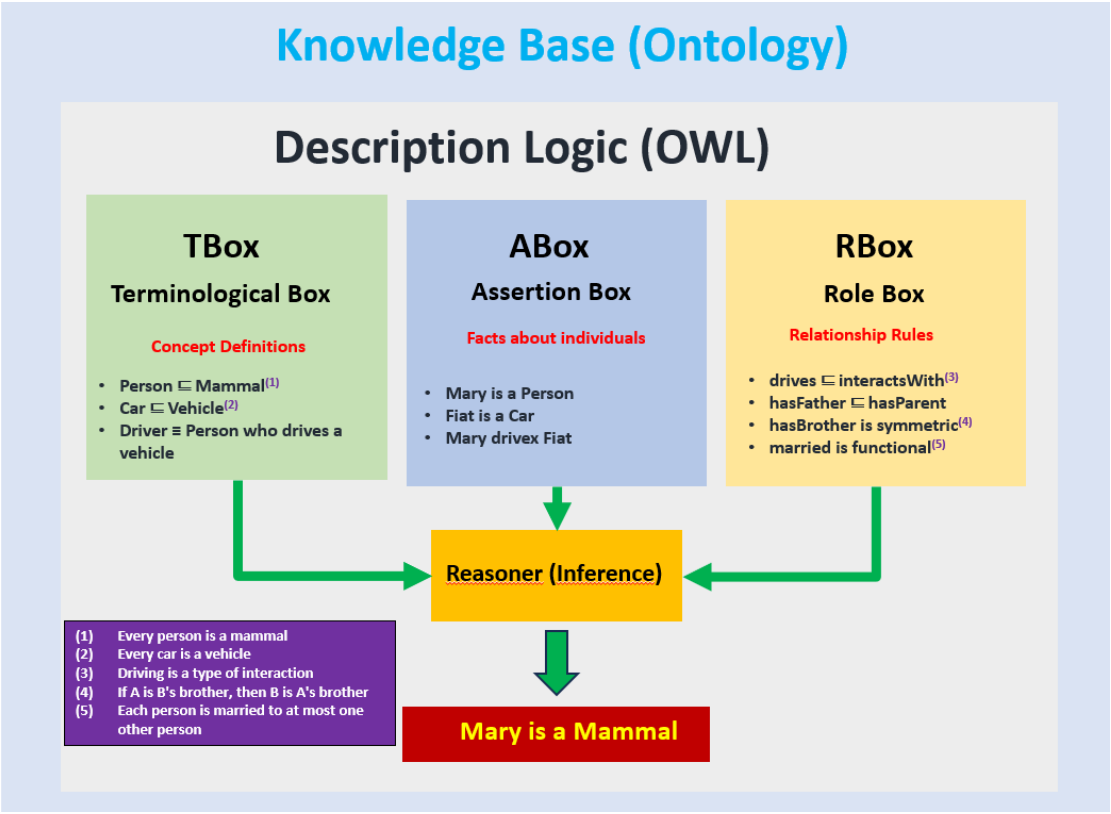


Figure 1: TBox, ABox e RBox form an ontology

[1]Domain-independent ontology that describes universal concepts applicable to any area of knowledge.

1.1 Contributions

The main contributions of this work are:

- an ontology-driven reference model for II centred on *Node–Connection–Channel*, grounded in UFO and developed in OntoUML;
- an operationalisation in DL/OWL supporting automated reasoning over ***TBox***,***ABox***, and ***RBox***;
- a synchronisation approach aligning the KG with model-driven telemetry (e.g., YANG-Push) for near real-time state updates;
- a governance mechanism based on an **Ontological Compliance Regime** and SLA constraints, enabling auditable and explainable compliance checks; and
- a multi-agent Digital Twin architecture following the ***MAPE-K*** cycle (Kephart and Chess 2003; IBM Corporation 2005) for policy-driven actions.

1.2 Ontological Compliance Regime (overview)

The Ontological Compliance Regime is a normative layer (in other words, a governance mechanism) defined by ontological axioms and mediated by relators (Guizzardi 2005; Almeida, Guizzardi, Tiago P. Sales, et al. 2019; Almeida, Guizzardi, Tiago Prince Sales, et al. 2026). It enables the Digital Twin to determine which constraints (e.g., legislation, SLAs, privacy policies) apply to entities and data flows, and to propagate these constraints across nodes, connections, and channels through automated reasoning.

The main characteristics and functions of this regime include:

- **Automated Propagation:** By employing a logical reasoner, the regime propagates normative constraints across nodes, connections, and network channels. If a node is bound to a specific legal norm, all connections and channels mediated by it inherit those same constraints.
- **Jurisdiction Redefinition:** In this model, jurisdiction ceases to be a mere static hardware attribute delimited by physical geography, and is instead understood as a normative entity based on meaning, context, and relations.
- **Legally Aware Infrastructure:** The regime transforms the infrastructure into a "legally aware" system, which means that the compliance of network operations is mathematically verified through DL.
- **Auditability and Explainability:** The regime ensures that compliance checks are both auditable and explainable. In dynamic events, such as failures or attacks, decisions taken by the MAPE-K cycle are only executed in the network after being logically validated by this normative base.

1.3 A practical roadmap for the DT-II project

DT-II is the name assigned to this project. This section describes its various components in detail.

The Figure 2 displays the proposed construction of the development architecture for the research project. It adopts an iterative and incremental cycle that articulates the Proof of Concept (PoC) and the Minimum Viable Product (MVP). While the Upper Ontology (TBox+RBox) provides rigorous conceptual grounding anchored in UFO/gUFO, the development of the Domain Ontology (ABox) occurs through continuous interaction between the emulated PoC and the MVP. The PoC acts as an agile testing environment for abstraction and modelling problem-solving in Containerlab[2], allowing the validation of conceptual competencies before deployment in the three operational complexity profiles of the MVP: ASN++ (high-complexity domain with global transit), ASN+ (medium-complexity edge/access domain), and IX (special traffic exchange domain). The entire ecosystem is maintained and reconfigured in near real-time by the Digital Twin through model-driven telemetry and automated reasoning.

Table 1 characterises each of the complexities required for participants in the preliminary tests that will result in either the PoC or MVP. This is an initial approach to this classification and will be assessed *a posteriori* by other team members, with specific characteristics possibly being added or removed to ensure effective characterisation for the final choice.

The maintenance of the original proposal involving the construction of the PoC through simulation is strengthened by the following arguments, which together are methodologically sound:

- Speed in topology construction, i.e., reduced latency in learning: The PoC allows rapid iteration over modelling failures in OntoUML/Protégé and Python code without depending on complex topologies of multiple ASes.

[2]Containerlab is an open-source tool that enables the creation and management of container-based network laboratories in a fast, lightweight, and declarative manner, using YAML files to define topologies and interconnect real network operating systems.

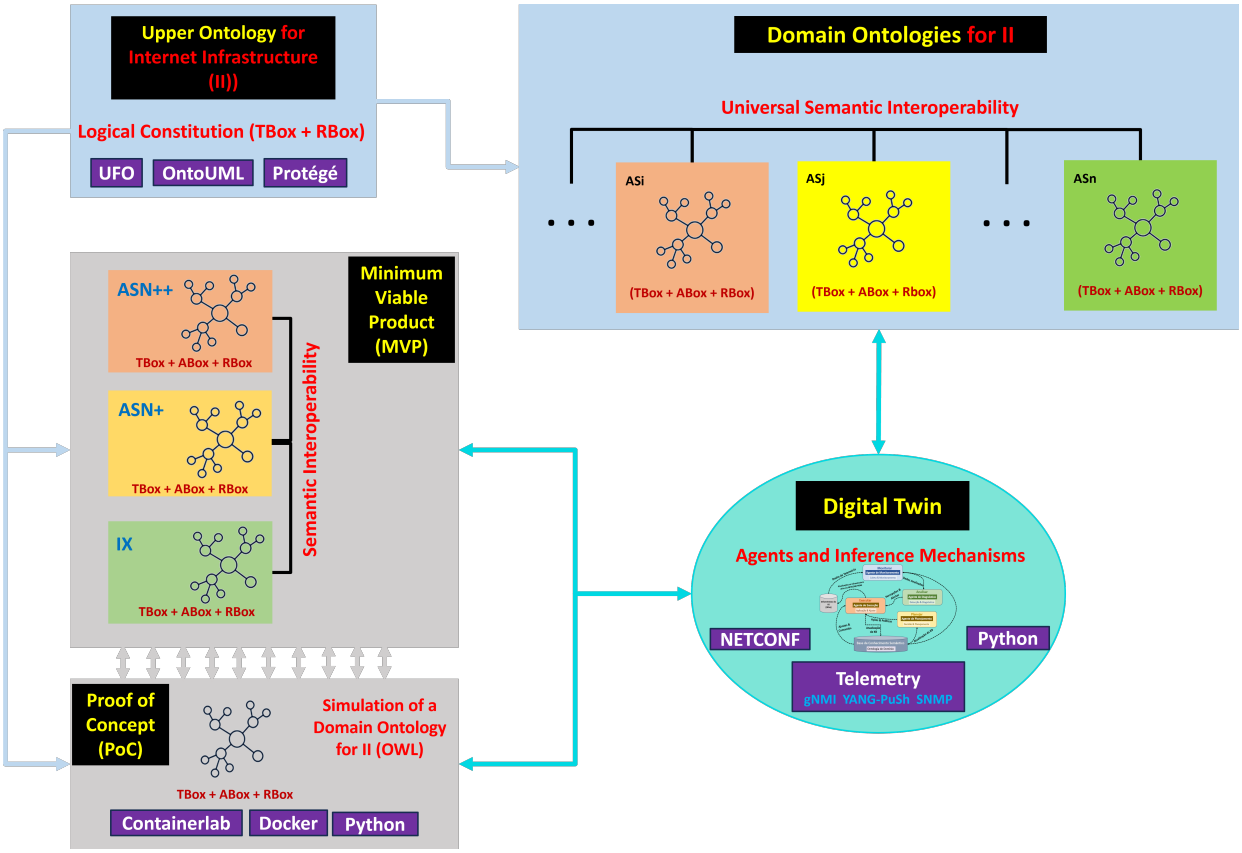


Figure 2: Architecture of the PoC and MVP proposal, across three operational environments with different characteristics in terms of complexity. These three types of complexity are classified as ASN++ (***High Complexity Domain***), ASN+ (***Medium Complexity Domain***), and IX (***Special Domain***), all characterised in the text that follows. There is continuous interaction between the PoC and the MVP, mainly aimed at solving problems during the development of domain ontologies: abstraction and problem-solving.

Table 1: Classification of MVP participants, by level of complexity

High Complexity (ASN++)	Medium Complexity (ASN+)	Special Domain (IX)
Meet highly specialised and critical demands	Meet intermediate demands, with some level of specialisation	Meet a highly complex environment that centralises the interests of a large number of ASes of varying complexity
Robust infrastructure and advanced technology	Adequate infrastructure, but less sophisticated	Very complex infrastructure with highly diverse Internet traffic
Highly qualified multidisciplinary teams	Qualified technical teams, but less diverse	Highly qualified and diverse multidisciplinary teams
Services with high availability, redundancy, and security	Reliable services, but with less redundancy	Services with high availability and differentiated within the same environment
Integration with complex, large-scale systems	Moderate customisation capacity	Little or no integration capacity
Serve large corporations, public bodies, or strategic sectors	Serve medium-sized companies	Serve small, medium, large, and very large institutions with diverse service/-traffic demands
Bring the complexity of global routes, transit policies, and complex peering agreements	Bring the edge perspective, where regulations such as LGPD/SLA and local access policies apply	The neutral traffic exchange point, where the semantics of relators (multilateral BGP sessions, exchange agreements) are tested to the limit

- Heterogeneous representativeness: By extending the PoC to the MVP divided into ASN++, ASN+, and IX, the project gains strong validation arguments for the academic/IETF community, showing that the ontology is not limited to one type of network but unifies domains with entirely distinct operational and legal roles.

- Opportunistic change in project topology, without concerns related to clients, since in simulation they do not exist;
- Facilities in exercises and experiments that may lead to learning and improvement in the construction of domain ontologies, especially considering the perspective of topological abstraction, since we have UFO (or rather, gUFO). Topological abstraction can lead to a standard, implementable domain ontology with few changes in any Autonomous System[3] (AS). Additionally, it can assist in the gradual construction of the ABox, allowing small instances (synthetic ABox in the PoC) to be built and tested before dealing with the volume of assertions generated by continuous telemetry (gNMI, YANG-Push) across the three types of ASes in the MVP.
- There is no urgency in this research proposal. Both options, PoC and MVP, can coexist in the project, and simulation will improve the characterisation of MVP participants and even provide evaluation.

The strategy of including the MVP through three environments involving different complexities favours the improvement of project learning and broadens the development and recording of knowledge and lessons learned.

On 2026-09-28, the Internet had approximately **79,473** active Autonomous Systems (ASs) (Hawkinson and Bates 1996), as reported in the **CIDR IPv6 Report**[4] maintained by Geoff Huston, Chief Scientist from Asia-Pacific Network Information Centre (APNIC). Each AS possesses operational autonomy, with its functionality established by protocols and specialised administrators. The correctness of this functionality characterises the behaviour of the Internet from the user's perspective. A misconfiguration in one AS can propagate across the global II, causing worldwide incidents. For example, if an AS incorrectly announces an IPv4 block via the BGP protocol, it may cause serious damage, particularly to the legitimate holder of that block. One way to prevent anomalous behaviours in the AS environment is through measurements known as **telemetries**.

These risks highlight the need for advanced monitoring mechanisms. The DT-II project proposes the simulation of ontology-based techniques (or knowledge bases) capable of establishing intelligent telemetries without human intervention. Alongside ontologies, protocols such as NETCONF and related technologies are employed, widely deployed and implemented by major II equipment vendors.

The project employs two types of ontologies: domain ontologies (DOs), which specify the knowledge of each AS, and the UO, which ensures semantic interoperability and facilitates the construction and verification of DOs through the OntoUML tool. Although DOs are similar across most ASs, the innovation of the project lies in the use of the UO, which brings benefits such as:

- Ensuring semantic interoperability across different domains;
- Facilitating systematic construction and verification of DOs via OntoUML.

Additionally, the project uses *Protégé*, supported by gUFO, for modelling DOs both in the testbed and in ASs participating in the second phase of the research. The testbed, developed with ***Containerlab***, ***Docker***, and ***Python***, constitutes the DT-II PoC, enabling validation of the project's implementation.

The DT is the operational component of the project. It adopts the autonomic characteristics described in Richard Murch's book "Autonomic Computing" (Murch 2004) and is expected to behave in accordance with the eight elements proposed to preserve the characteristics of an autonomic computing system:

- Comprehensive self-knowledge, including available resources and operational capabilities
- Ability to configure and reconfigure itself autonomously in response to contextual requirements
- Capacity for continuous self-optimisation, ensuring sustained efficiency and performance
- Robust self-healing mechanisms to detect, isolate, and recover from failures
- Self-protection capabilities to safeguard against internal inconsistencies and external threats
- Ability to acquire and interpret knowledge of its environment and context, adapting behaviour accordingly
- Competence to operate effectively in heterogeneous and distributed computing environments
- Ability to anticipate, interpret, and adapt to evolving user requirements

A DT can maintain an environment that preserves the above elements (e.g., self-knowledge, self-configuration, self-optimisation, self-healing, and self-protection) if conceived as a **multi-agent** architecture supported by a semantic

[3] An Autonomous System (AS) is the fundamental unit of routing on the Internet, defined as a set of IP networks under a single routing policy and administration.

[4] `https://www.cidr-report.org/`

knowledge base. To this end, the DT follows the **MAPE-K** proposal (Kephart and Chess 2003; IBM Corporation 2005), which establishes the following cycle as a means of ensuring autonomy:

- **Monitoring (M)**: collects real-time data.
- **Analysis (A)**: interprets the data based on axioms and rules.
- **Planning (P)**: generates action plans consistent with the Normative Ontological Basis.
- **Execution (E)**: applies changes to the infrastructure.
- **Knowledge (K)**: feeds back into the knowledge base, ensuring continuous learning.

Figure 3 provides a detailed visual representation of the MAPE-K flow of the DT proposed in this article.

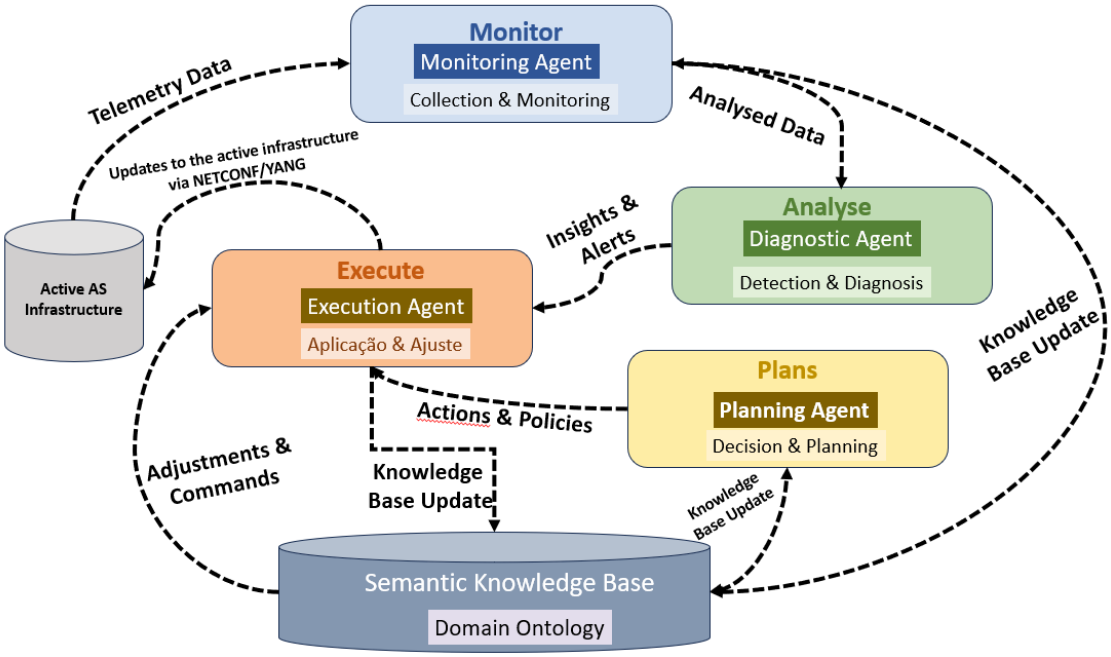


Figure 3: MAPE-K Flow of the Digital Twin

2 Related Work

This section positions DT-II in relation to three research strands: (i) **network digital twins** and closed-loop/autonomic management; (ii) **ontology-based network modelling** and knowledge graphs for inventory, topology, and intent; (iii) **telemetry-driven inference** and policy/compliance enforcement.

2.1 Network Digital Twins and Autonomic Control

Digital Twins provide a digital counterpart of an operational system, enabling monitoring, diagnosis, and actuation (Grieves and Vickers 2017). In networking, recent proposals emphasise closed-loop control, model-driven operations, and integration with telemetry (Zhou et al. 2026). DT-II differs by making the twin *explicitly governed* by a superior Normative Ontological Basis, so that actions are validated against semantics and constraints rather than solely metrics or learned policies.

2.2 Ontologies and Knowledge Graphs for Network Infrastructure

Knowledge graphs have been applied to integrate heterogeneous network data sources and to support inter-domain queries such as in Thomas et al. (2026). Ontology-driven approaches add explicit meaning, identity criteria, and constraints, enabling consistency checking and explainable inference. DT-II builds upon this line by grounding its

central model in UFO (via OntoUML/gUFO), explicitly modelling roles and relators, and using this structure as a foundation for interoperability across multiple administrative domains.

2.3 Telemetry, Model-driven Interfaces, and Reasoning

Modern network management increasingly relies on streaming telemetry and model-driven interfaces (e.g., YANG-based mechanisms) to maintain near real-time state. DT-II adopts model-driven telemetry via YANG-Push (RFC 8641) (Clemm and Voit 2019), as its synchronisation mechanism, combining it with DL reasoning over ***TBox/RBox/ABox*** to detect inconsistencies and to derive governance-relevant states (e.g., SLA violations, jurisdictional conflicts).

2.4 Governance, Policies, and Compliance

Whilst policy frameworks typically impose restrictions through configuration templates or procedural checks, DT-II formalises governance as part of the ontology itself (e.g., Ontological Compliance Regime, SLA relators). This enables automated validation, traceability, and explainability of compliance decisions across domains.

3 Methodology

This project follows the ontology engineering lifecycle (Keet 2025; Parks 2025; Effingham 2013), employing the ***Unified Foundational Ontology*** (UFO) as its basis and OntoUML as the modelling language (Guizzardi 2005). The process is structured into four technical phases:

M1. **Conceptual abstraction**: UFO is applied to classify II assets. Rigid essence types (`PhysicalElement`, `MaterialMedium`) provide identity, whilst anti-rigid roles (`NetworkNode`, `CommunicationChannel`) are mediated by relators.

M2. **Formalisation in Description Logic (DL)**: The resulting conceptual model is axiomatised in DL to ensure computational interpretability. For example, every `NetworkNode` must possess a logical identifier:

$$\text{NetworkNode} \sqsubseteq \text{PhysicalElement} \sqcap \exists \text{possesses.LogicalIdentifier} \tag{1}$$

M3. **Semantic serialisation**: Models validated in ***OLED*** are exported to OWL and serialised in ***Turtle***. Standard vocabularies (e.g., ***Dublin Core*** and ***FOAF***) provide support for metadata and provenance.

M4. **Automated reasoning**: DL reasoners query the ***TBox*** and ***ABox*** to check consistency and to derive governance-relevant states. For instance, an inactive channel can be used to infer compromise (or invalidation) of the corresponding logical connection.

3.1 Ontological Analysis Structure and Mapping Process

The mapping between the II domain and UFO, via its gUFO implementation, follows a specialisation protocol grounded in logical metaproperties. For each local domain entity, the **Ontological Analysis Structure** is applied (Almeida, Guizzardi, Tiago Prince Sales, et al. 2026; Almeida, Guizzardi, Tiago P. Sales, et al. 2019; Guizzardi 2005):

A. **Specialisation of Fundamental Types**: Entities with rigid identity and specific individuation principles (e.g., Physical Routers, Satellites, Fibre Cables) are mapped as subclasses of *gufo:Kind*. These represent substantial objects that persist independently of their configuration state.

B. **Relational Specialisation (Roles)**: Concepts whose existence depends on a specific topological or functional context (e.g., Edge Node, Peering Point, Transit AS) are characterised as *gufo:Role*. This allows the Digital Twin to capture the dynamic nature of network functions independently of the underlying hardware.

C. **Relational Foundations**: Logical connections and service agreements establishing dependencies between multiple objects (e.g., BGP Sessions, SLA Agreements) are formalised as *gufo:Relator*. This ensures that the integrity of the Knowledge Graph is maintained through existential dependency constraints inherent to gUFO, where invalidation of a relator triggers logical removal of the associated roles.

By employing this structure, DT-II transcends mere data modelling, establishing a **Normative Ontological Basis** in which network behaviour is governed by foundational ontological axioms rather than purely heuristic or statistical patterns.

3.2 Dynamic Synchronisation via YANG-Push

A critical requirement for DT-II is high-fidelity synchronisation between the physical infrastructure and its semantic representation. To achieve this, the model employs *Model-Driven Telemetry* (MDT) through the **YANG-Push** mechanism (RFC 8641 (Clemm and Voit 2019)).

Unlike traditional query-based monitoring (*pull*), YANG-Push enables Network Nodes to directly transmit state changes to the *Semantic Ingestor*. This integration is mapped into the gUFO framework as follows:

- **Periodic Subscriptions**: Quantitative metrics, such as interface counters, are transmitted to update `gufo:Quality` assertions in the ABox.
- **Change Notifications**: Critical events, such as oscillations in BGP sessions, are treated as `gufo:Events` that immediately trigger re-evaluation of existential dependencies in `gufo:Relators`.

This ensures that the Normative Ontological Basis of the Digital Twin always reflects the current operational state of ASs with latency below one second.

4 Relations between Ontology, Knowledge Graph, and Description Logic

The ***Knowledge Graph*** (KG) operationalises the ontology by linking **real data** (instances) to the conceptual model. It represents information as **nodes** (entities) connected by **edges** (relations). For example, an instance `inst:Router_R1` may be linked to `inst:Router_R2` via `ii:connectedTo`, and the resulting `ii:Connection` may be linked to an `ii:Channel` with capacity and latency qualities. Typically, a KG integrates multiple sources to form a network of interconnected facts.

Ontology and KG are **complementary**: the ontology provides semantics and logical rules, whilst the KG instantiates them as a dynamic and queryable knowledge base. Table 2 summarises their roles in the proposed framework.

Table 2: Complementarity between Ontology and Knowledge Graph

Characteristic	Ontology	Knowledge Graph
Focus	Definitions, rules, logic.	Data, facts, connections.
Level	Abstract (the "DNA").	Concrete (the "Organism").
Function	Provides meaning and semantics.	Enables queries and discoveries.

Description Logic (DL) underpins modern ontologies (e.g., OWL in the Semantic Web) (Baader et al. 2017). DL enables the formal definition of concepts and computational reasoning. For example, the axiom:

$$\text{NetworkNode} \sqsubseteq \text{PhysicalElement}$$

establishes that every `NetworkNode` is a `PhysicalElement`. More complex definitions employ logical connectives, such as:

$$\text{NetworkNode} \sqsubseteq \exists \text{possesses}.\text{LogicalIdentifier}$$

indicating that every `NetworkNode` possesses at least one `LogicalIdentifier`. Here, $\sqcap$ denotes intersection (AND) and $\exists$ denotes existence, enabling precise expression of semantic constraints.

In summary, the ontology provides the logical and semantic structure, whilst the KG materialises this structure in concrete data. DL acts as the formal link between them, ensuring consistency, interpretability, and inferential capability. This triad — Ontology, KG, and DL — constitutes the methodological core of DT-II, enabling the II to be represented, monitored, and governed in a semantic and dynamic manner.

5 Conceptual Structure of the Digital Twin

This section presents a **reference architecture** for implementing the II Digital Twin as an **operational KG** (***ABox***) governed by an ***UO*** (***TBox***, ***RBox***). The aim is to make the model executable: to collect, normalise, validate, infer, and support decisions. The implementation objectives are:

(a) **Unified semantic inventory**: represent nodes, connections, and channels independently of technology;
(b) **Continuous synchronisation**: align the KG with telemetry and topology changes;
(c) **Detection and diagnosis**: identify inconsistencies, failures, and cascading impacts;
(d) **Verifiable governance**: encode and audit rules (SLA, jurisdiction, authorisation).

5.1 Minimal Data Model

The initial implementation focuses on three entities:

(a) **Node**: identity (`hasIdentifier`), operational state, timestamp;
(b) **Connection**: endpoints (`connectNode`), supported channel, metrics (latency, loss, jitter);
(c) **Channel**: medium type (fibre, copper, radio), capacity, QoS policy.

5.2 Integration of *ABox* and *RBox*

The ***ABox*** instantiates infrastructure elements (routers, links, channels) from inventory data (Claise, Clarke, and Lindblad 2019). The ***RBox***, based on $\mathcal{SROIQ}$ logic (Horrocks, Kutz, and Sattler 2006), governs relational properties:

(a) **Transitivity**: deduces cascading failures;
(b) **Mereology**: validates part–whole relations for SLA compliance (Effingham 2013, Ch. 8);
(c) **Property chains**: enable bidirectional navigation and anomaly tracing.

Together, ***ABox*** and ***RBox*** transform the KG into a computable model, enabling dynamic reasoning and governance.

5.3 Operational Flow

F1. Ingestion → normalisation → triple generation.
F2. Validation → integrity checks and anomaly detection.
F3. Inference → classification and rule-based derivations.
F4. Query/alert → recommendations or automated orchestration.

5.4 Example Scenario

In a link failure:

(a) telemetry marks the `Channel` as unavailable;
(b) inference classifies the `Connection` as `InactiveConnection` and derives `SLAViolation`;
(c) redundancy is triggered (e.g., satellite backup).

In summary, the Digital Twin evolves into an **executable knowledge system**, where the ***TBox*** governs meanings and rules, and ***ABox*/*RBox*** capture state, validate consistency, and enable inference, transforming data into actionable decisions.

5.5 Reference Architecture

As a consequence, the reference architecture can be established, organised into seven layers:

(i) **Ontological Layer (*TBox*)**: defines core classes (`NetworkNode`, `Connection`, `Channel`) and constraints;
(ii) **Identity Layer**: assigns stable IRIs to instances, separating identity from state;
(iii) **Ingestion Layer**: collects telemetry (YANG-Push, gNMI, SNMP, syslog) and normalises data into the Node–Connection–Channel triad;
(iv) **Persistence Layer (*ABox*, *RBox*)**: stores facts in RDF/OWL and maintains temporal history via observations;
(v) **Validation Layer**: applies structural constraints and logical consistency checks with DL reasoners;
(vi) **Reasoning Layer**: infers states (`DegradedConnection`, `SLAViolation`) and propagates failures;
(vii) **Exposure Layer**: provides SPARQL queries, dashboards, alerts, and integration with NOC/orchestration systems.

A graphical view of these seven layers is available in Figure 4.

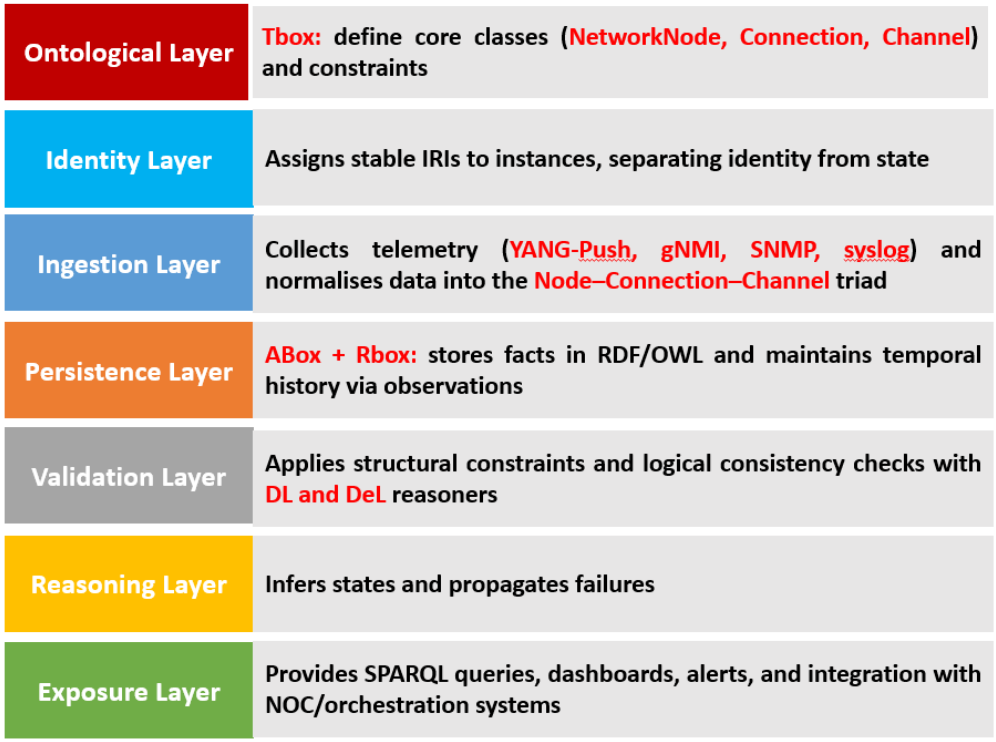


Figure 4: Graphical view of the Reference Architecture of the DT Conceptual Framework

6 Use Cases

6.1 Use Case I: Ontological Compliance Regime and Logical Governance in DT-II

The Ontological Compliance Regime (characterised in 1.2) is the governance mechanism of **DT-II** that establishes authority and policy compliance over digital entities based on meaning, context, and relations — transcending traditional geophysical boundaries. In this model, jurisdiction ceases to be a static hardware attribute and becomes a **normative entity mediated by relators**.

6.1.1 Foundation and Axiomatisation

Defined in the ***TBox*** through restriction axioms, the Ontological Compliance Regime employs the Reasoner to determine which norms (e.g., LGPD, GDPR, SLAs) apply to real-time data flows. In the ***RBox***, property chains formalise propagation: if a `NetworkNode` is linked to a legal norm, all `Channels` and `Connections` mediated by relators inherit the same constraints.

6.1.2 Role of the Digital Twin

The Digital Twin acts as the guardian of jurisdiction. By ingesting telemetry (gNMI, YANG-Push, SNMP), the system populates the ***ABox***. Through **Semantic Elevation**, it verifies, for example, whether a health data packet traverses a node under a jurisdiction that does not meet the privacy requirements defined in the ***TBox***.

6.1.3 Operationalisation and Resilience

In dynamic events (e.g., DDoS attacks, BGP failures), the Ontological Compliance Regime guides the **MAPE-K** cycle: (a) **Analysis**: the reasoner detects violations of jurisdiction axioms; (b) **Planning**: the system seeks compliant alternatives; (c) **Execution**: configuration is applied via ***NETCONF*** only after logical validation.

In summary, the Ontological Compliance Regime transforms infrastructure into a ***juridically aware*** system, where compliance is mathematically verified by DL, ensuring governance integrity in complex and mutable networks.

6.2 Use Case II: Model Behaviour under a DDoS Attack

In a Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) attack, response time is critical. The Digital Twin acts as a Semantic Defence System, leveraging the ***TBox***, ***RBox***, and ***ABox*** within the ***MAPE-K*** cycle as follows:

- **Monitoring** Telemetry (gNMI, YANG-Push, SNMP) updates the ***ABox*** in real time. For example, a traffic spike from 1 Gbps to 100 Gbps is recorded as:

  ```
  inst:Unusual_Flow a ii:AnomalousFlow
  ```

- **Analysis** The Reasoner applies property chains from the ***RBox***: (a) the anomalous flow saturates `Channel_Alpha`; (b) transitivity propagates risk to dependent services (e.g., DNS); (c) the origin is traced to a specific **Ontological Compliance Regime**.
- **Planning** Consulting the ***TBox***, the system applies rules: if a critical service is at risk and the origin is external, mitigation (Blackholing or Rate Limiting) must occur at the edge. The plan prioritises nodes sustaining the network's **Ontological Normative Base**.
- **Execution** Logical decisions are translated into technical commands. Via ***NETCONF***, edge routers are reconfigured to filter malicious traffic.
- **Advantages of the Semantic Approach** Unlike conventional defences that block IPs, **DT-II** enables: (a) **Context Awareness**: cooperation agreements mapped in the ontology may trigger governance APIs instead of simple blocking; (b) **Mereological Resilience**: the Reasoner may sacrifice non-vital channels to preserve critical services; (c) **Traceability**: each mitigation step is explainable, linked to axioms in the ***TBox***; (d) **Compliance**: no action is executed without validation by the ***Ontological Normative Base***.
- **Sequence Flow** Mitigation occurs within milliseconds, moving from the **Active Infrastructure** to the **Logical Core** and back. Figure 5 illustrates the process.

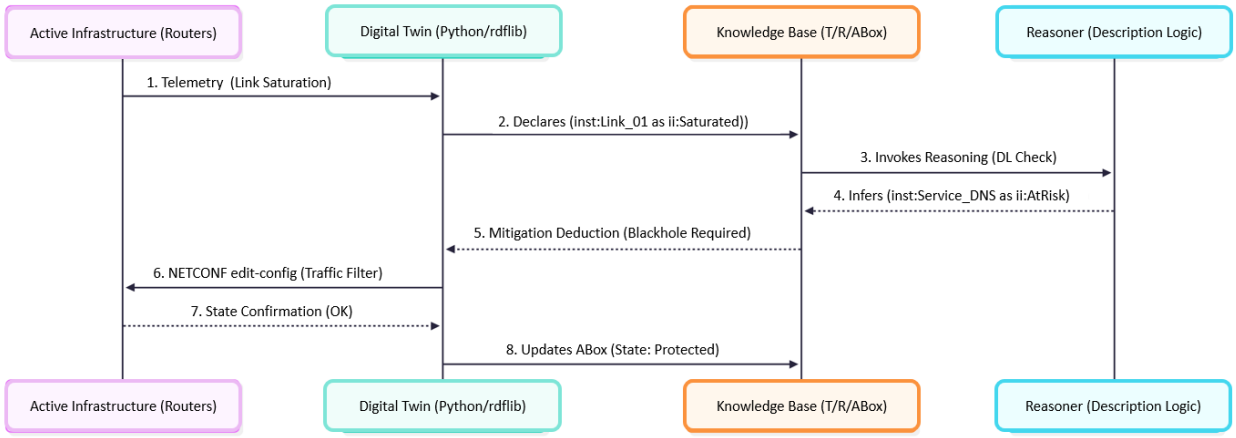


Figure 5: Sequence Diagram of DDoS Mitigation via DT-II

In summary, the ontology-based approach enables **policy-driven mitigation**, where assets of higher semantic and contractual value are prioritised, ensuring resilience and governance integrity.

7 Why the II Requires a Project like DT-II

The II must be understood not merely as cables and protocols, but as a **living system** that has already surpassed the limits of manual management. The **DT-II** project is necessary for four reasons: (R1) **From Static Management to Semantic Autonomy**: Current II management relies on rigid scripts and manual CLI commands. DT-II introduces **Logical Reasoning**, enabling the system to deduce solutions for complex failures and attacks under an ***Ontological Normative Base***; (R2) **NETCONF as an Interoperability Catalyst**: The growing adoption of ***NETCONF*** provides a vendor-independent, standardised channel for the Digital Twin to interact with the **Active Infrastructure**, updating ***ABox*** instances in real time; (R3) **Global Semantic Governance**: In a fragmented regulatory scenario (e.g., LGPD, GDPR), DT-II encodes laws and SLAs as axioms, ensuring compliance regardless of geographic routing complexity;

(R4) **Universal Semantic Interoperability**: Grounded in the ***UO*** (that is, ***UFO***), DT-II resolves data silos, acting as a universal translator across domains (5G, Satellite, SD-WAN[5]), reducing costs and integration errors.

In summary, without DT-II, II remains an **Active Infrastructure** — processing packets without context. With DT-II, II gains **State Awareness**, evolving into an **Autonomic Network** that understands what it moves, why it moves, and whether it has logical permission to do so.

8 Conceptual Expansions of DT-II

This section deepens theoretical and practical aspects that complement the initial DT-II proposal, consolidating foundations and anticipating implementation challenges.

8.1 Inter-Domain Multi-Agent Coordination

Although the MAPE-K architecture is already described for internal agents, it is necessary to detail how multiple *Digital Twins* from different ASs interact. Inter-agent communication protocols such as FIPA-ACL or KQML may be employed for message exchange between graphs. In distributed attack scenarios (e.g., DDoS), planning agents from different ASs must negotiate routes and mitigation strategies, establishing consensus or federation among multiple MAPE-K cycles (Weyns et al. 2012).

8.2 Computational Scalability and *Stream Reasoning*

The use of expressive description logic (SROIQ) ensures semantic rigour but may generate bottlenecks in globally scaled ABoxes. To maintain millisecond-level response times, we propose the use of *Stream Reasoning* techniques and logical partitions of the ABox. This approach enables incremental reasoning over continuous data streams, ensuring DT-II operates in critical environments without compromising performance (Quin, Weyns, and Gheibi 2021; Andersson et al. 2023).

8.3 Conflict Resolution in the Ontological Normative Base

The Ontological Compliance Regime evaluates plans against strict rules, yet conflicts are inevitable in real infrastructures. For instance, the self-protection rule may clash with high-availability SLA requirements. Indeed, dealing with conflicting decisions and the adaptation actions they imply is recognised in the literature as one of the main open challenges for advancing self-adaptive systems (Quin, Weyns, and Gheibi 2021). To address this limitation and handle such situations, we suggest the use of defeasible logic[6] or ontological weight hierarchies (Antoniou et al. 2001; Nute 2003; Governatori and Maher 2017; Governatori, Olivieri, et al. 2013; Governatori, Padmanabhan, et al. 2009; García and Simari 2004; Grimm and Hitzler 2008; Lutz, Manière, and Nolte 2023; Sengupta, Krisnadhi, and Hitzler 2011). This approach enables the inference engine to resolve conflicting axioms in a consistent and transparent manner, within non-monotonic reasoning.

9 Conclusion and Future Work

This paper presented the conceptual foundations of **DT-II**, a multi-agent Digital Twin for II based on Ontology, Knowledge Graphs, and Description Logic. By formalising governance through the **Ontological Compliance Regime** and enabling policy-driven responses to complex events such as DDoS attacks, the model advances the vision of transforming II from a passive infrastructure into a **juridically aware autonomic system**. The proposed architecture demonstrates how ontological rigour can ensure resilience, compliance, and semantic interoperability in heterogeneous domains. All project results will be available at `https://github.com/LJuliaoBraga/dtii`.

Future work will focus on:

(i) simulation of the Digital Twin to evaluate alarms in ASs;

(ii) experimental validation of spatio-temporal response mechanisms;

[5]Software-Defined Wide Area Network, a software-based approach to WAN management.

[6]It is a logical system that admits conclusions based on rules that may be defeated by other rules or contrary evidence. In classical logic, once something is deduced, it cannot be withdrawn (monotonic reasoning). In defeasible logic, however, conclusions may be revised.

(iii) integration with programmable infrastructures via ***NETCONF***;

(iv) exploration of semantic interoperability in domains such as 5G, satellite, and SD-WAN;

(v) participation in the evaluation of the two proposed telemetry alternatives — YANG-Push and gNMI — while remaining open to those that may emerge in the near future; and

(vi) Integration with Quantum Key Distribution (QKD) and Quantum Internet: We plan to explore the use of Quantum Communication channels for transmitting highly sensitive telemetry and governance metadata between the Active Infrastructure and the Digital Twin. As DT-II deals with critical "Semantic Jurisdictions" involving state-level privacy and strategic infrastructure topology, QKD integration will ensure synchronisation between the physical and logical layers remains secure even against future adversarial threats from quantum computing, maintaining the integrity of the "Ontological Normative Base" through a proven secure quantum-classical hybrid architecture (Kozlowski et al. 2023; Wang et al. 2024; Meter 2014). Future integration with Quantum Key Distribution (QKD) and Quantum Internet is a strategic differentiator of DT-II. We propose a hybrid architecture in which the Ontological Normative Base connects to quantum hardware to guarantee inviolable channels between the active infrastructure and the *Digital Twin*. This layer ensures that the MAPE-K cycle is not compromised by adversarial injections or tampering, reinforcing system resilience and security. By incorporating inter-domain multi-agent coordination, scalability via continuous synchronisation, normative conflict resolution, and quantum hybrid architecture, DT-II evolves from a conceptual proposal into an applicable engineering *framework*, capable of addressing the practical challenges of the Internet of the future.

In addition to the proposals listed above, it is worth highlighting the possibility of applying to DT-II the intelligent agents' architecture developed by Juliao Braga (2019) and previously explored in Julião Braga, Omar, and Granville (2015), and later in Juliao Braga, Stiubiener, and Henriques (2025). This integration may enhance the capacity for knowledge acquisition in restricted domains and strengthen the governance of ASs, contributing to greater efficiency, security, and explainability of the indicated actions, particularly in the application of the MAPE-K flow (Figure 3).

These steps aim to evolve the conceptual model design towards experimental deployment, culminating in its submission in 2026 as a draft to the IRTF ***nmrg*** within the CGI-IETF initiative, in collaboration with the following Brazilian universities: **IFSPe** (PE), **ITA** (SP), **UFABC** (SP), **UFRGS** (RS), and **UNICAP** (PE).

10 Acknowledgements

The authors thank CGI.br for supporting the CGI-IETF Project, as well as the research groups and universities involved. Special thanks to colleagues and students who contributed with discussions, preliminary experiments, and ontological modelling activities.

Declaration on Generative AI

During the preparation of this work, the authors Gemini and Copilot, exclusively, for grammar and spelling checks in Portuguese and English. Support was obtained for translations and relevant evaluations. All substantive content, analyses, and conclusions were produced by the authors, who reviewed and edited the text as necessary and assume full responsibility for the content of the publication.

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